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Tube It Up

As the battle over which is better—LCD or CRT—continues, we take a close look at some of the options in the CRT category

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A monitor is your window to an exciting virtual world that your hardware and peripherals work quietly to produce. Whether it's a movie, game or Web page, your viewing experience depends heavily on your monitor's size and performance.

An good example is the feeling of euphoria you get when you upgrade from a 15-inch screen to a 17-inch or a 19-inch monitor; an even better example is the dismal experience of having to make do with a 15-inch monitor after being used to the 17-inch or the 19-inch one for quite some time.

Although your graphics card plays a key role in what the image on your screen looks like, your monitor is equally important. Sharpness, colour reproduction, refresh rate and resolution define a monitor's capabilities. And this chain of features is only as strong as its weakest link—if the monitor underperforms in any of these areas, you end up dissatisfied.

We tested 27 monitors; 18 were 17-inch, and nine were 19-inch monitors. The products came to us from nine vendors, and came in beige, black and dual-tone. Some were both beige and black. As black cabinets are popular nowadays, black monitors are a must to maintain uniformity—and cost, on average, Rs 500 extra.

Since we can't go about switching monitors for each task we perform, monitors need to be all-rounders, and should be capable of offering you the best possible experience while gaming, working on text documents, watching movies or surfing the Net.

Flat And Flatter

If you thought monitors were either normal or flat, think again. Now you have even flatter screens, also known as 'true-flat' screens. This difference is justified when you see the differences between each vendors' 'flat' model and their 'true-flat' model. The regular flat models display irregularities at the corners, and though the screen appears flat, the same does not